and we took 93,000 prisoners of war. It was one of our best-fought wars. The nation celebrates 16 December every year as Vijay Diwas.

After the war was over, I returned to Poona and resumed my duties. Soon I was ordered to proceed to Dhana, a small military station in central India, where we had set up a camp for Pakistani POWs. I was assigned to interrogate the important POWs. There were almost a thousand prisoners in that camp. It was very interesting to hear their account of the war. There were some who did not reveal anything more than their name, rank and unit, and kept shut. There were many others who, when engaged in a conversation, revealed everything they knew. There was a third category of POWs who were angry with their leadership and their generals who had put them in this mess and brought humiliation to Pakistan. They were the most forthcoming. I remember one of them telling me that we Indians didn't even know 'how to kill' someone properly! I did not realize the import of his statement at that time. (Three decades later, when a few of our soldiers' badly mutilated bodies were returned after the Kargil War, these words flashed back in my memory.)

All 93,000 Pakistani POWs were treated fairly by us as laid down in the Geneva conventions. No third-degree methods were employed, as there were strict orders to that effect. There were many families in the station, particularly the ladies, who wanted to see the Pakistanis. I remember one middle-aged major who was the second-in-command of 31 Baluch, an infantry battalion that was defending Jamalpur. In his diary he had recorded a graphic description of the battle of Jamalpur, of how brilliantly the Indian Army engaged them frontally, while they cut off the rear by placing an effective road block. Thereafter, the Baluchis were attacked from the exposed flanks and the rear where their defences were weak and uncoordinated. I asked him, 'How is it that you lost so badly?' He replied that it was because the 'awaam' (the public) was against them and that this was also due to good leadership displayed by the Indians. This gallant action was undertaken by 1 Maratha LI (Jangi Paltan), led by Lieutenant Colonel K.S. Brar, who was decorated with a Vir Chakra for this operation. The battalion got a large